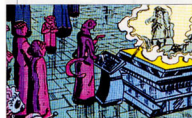




FIREBIRD

BONITA JUAREZ was sure she had been singled out for greatness. A young

American Indian living with her grandmother, Bonita was walking in the desert one night near Albuquerque, New Mexico, when a huge ball of cold fire crashed down from the sky, bathing her in unknown radiations. She soon discovered that she could fly and project blasts of heat from her body in the rough shape of a bird.



INSPIRED

Bonita believed the fireball was a gift from the firebird, a legendary creature of Native American myth. She fashioned a costume and began using her powers to

fight crime and to help people. Although Bonita later learned that her powers were the result of waste products generated by an alien race's experiments, she didn't lose confidence in her heroic role as Firebird.

The Rangers

In a situation that echoed the Avengers' origin, Firebird intercepted a distress call about the Hulk on a rampage in the Southwestern U.S.A. When she arrived there, she met other crime-fighters—Red Wolf, Texas Twister, Shooting Star, and the Night Rider. Calling themselves the Rangers, the heroes banded together to protect the region.



West Coast Comrades

Firebird first met the West Coast Avengers when she traveled to Los Angeles to battle Master Pandemonium, an ex-movie actor who had turned to sorcery. She traveled with the Avengers to the dimension of the Cat People, fought alongside the team against a demonic Shooting Star, and helped rescue the Avengers when they were trapped in the past. However, Firebird never became a member.



PANDEMONIUM REIGNS

Master Pandemonium's body was a gateway for demonic forces. Firebird blasted him with a fireball to no avail.



LA ESPIRITA

While calling herself *La Espritita*, Bonita grew close to Hank Pym.



BIG BERTHA

Bertha can absorb bullets fired at her by a machine-gun, using into her considerable body—and fire them right back at him!

THE ROLL CALL

The lineup of Mr. Immortal's Great Lakes Avengers team would comprise: Doorman, a living portal; Ashley Crawford, alias Big Bertha, a supermodel who could increase her size and strength to superhuman levels; Dr. Ventura, alias Flatman, who could make his body wafer thin; the alien named Dinah Shore, who could fly and generate blasts of sonic energy; and, later, Squirrel Girl, who could communicate with squirrels.

Team work

The GLA assisted the West Coasters against an alien virus which called itself "That Which Endures" and claimed to control the evolutionary process of all life on Earth. They were later tricked into attacking Captain America in a failed attempt to steal his indestructible shield.



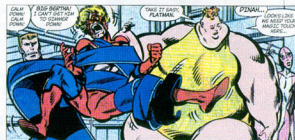
NEW RECRUIT

Dinah Shore was killed by Maestrom, who could control kinetic energy. Her replacement, Doug Taggart, had a costume that mimicked a grasshopper's powers, but did not survive long.

GREAT LAKES AVENGERS

CRAIG HOLLIS couldn't die. He played with alligators, held exploding sticks of dynamite, drank toxic chemicals—but

never came to harm. It finally dawned on him that he was blessed with a super-power and he decided to become Mr. Immortal, a crime-fighter. His ability couldn't stop criminals, so he advertised for help; some decidedly unusual individuals replied.



Dinah's Magic Words

Although an arrogant hothead, Mr. Immortal truly loved Dinah Shore, a member of an ancient and unknown race with razor-sharp wings. Craig was the only one on the team who understood her alien tongue. Faced with the prospect of dealing with the press, who were clamoring for information about the new team, he had a sudden, violent attack of nerves. Fortunately, the unearthly Dinah Shore managed to calm him down with a few, well-chosen "hypersonic" words.

